

UNITED NATIONS **NATIONS UNIES**
DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT
2025-2026**

Fellowship Award Specification

**United Nations World Food Programme (WFP)
East and Southern Africa Regional Office (ESARO)**

1. General Information

<u>Title:</u>	UN Fellow
<u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>	May 2026 (tbc)
<u>Assignment in the field dates:</u>	May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)
<u>Duty Station:</u>	Nairobi, Kenya
<u>Sector of assignment:</u>	Social Protection

2. Supervision

<u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>	Ms. Sheila Nkunika
<u>Title of the Supervisor:</u>	Regional Social Protection Advisor -ESARO

3. Background information

The United Nations World Food Programme (WFP) is the world's largest humanitarian agency with operations in over 80 countries. WFP is well known for its ability to deliver food assistance rapidly to people in need and help governments and communities build long-term food security and resilience against crises like conflict and climate change. In 2020, WFP was the recipient of the Nobel Peace Prize awarded for "...its efforts to combat hunger; for its contribution to bettering conditions for peace in conflict-affected areas and for acting as a driving force in efforts to prevent the use of hunger as a weapon of war".

WFP implements its programmes across the globe to achieve five corporate strategic outcomes which are:

1. People are better able to meet their urgent food and nutrition needs
2. People have better nutrition, health and education outcomes

3. People have improved and sustainable livelihoods
4. National programmes and systems are strengthened
5. Humanitarian and development actors are more efficient and effective

WFP aims to not only respond to shocks like conflicts, climate crises, and economic downturns, but to also proactively build resilience and reduce the impact of these events on food and nutrition security. This is achieved by designing and implementing interventions such as social protection in collaboration with governments, local actors, and communities to ensure ownership and long-term sustainability.

The Regional Office for East and Southern Africa (ESARO) is responsible for supporting country offices in developing and implementing programs that contribute to these objectives, as well as to UN Sustainable Development Goals 2 and 17. The regional office provides strategic guidance, technical support and direction to WFP country offices across the region.¹ Currently the regional office supports 22 countries.

The ESARO Social Protection Unit is part of the Regional Programme Unit in Nairobi. Social protection is a growing portfolio of work in the region, with all 22 countries engaged in support of national social protection systems. The Regional SP team is the first line of support for COs with regards to their SP operations and plays a key role in identifying opportunities to further key regional strategic shifts and to improve the quality of WFP social protection programming. The unit seeks to meet Country Offices support needs in ways that enhance the quality of engagement in national and subnational social protection dialogues, system strengthening, and direct cash-based assistance working through and in complement to national systems. The team also has a strong capacity building and knowledge management agenda

4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:

Under the supervision of the regional social protection advisor, the selected Fellow will be a key player in providing technical support to country offices and in social protection knowledge management. Specifically, the fellow will have the following responsibilities:

Provide social protection technical support to country office (CO) teams

- Contribute towards the development of CO projects and plans, ensuring alignment with corporate policies and guidance relevant to social protection.
- Provide project management support to specific and defined social protection programmes and projects,
- Ensure a coordinated approach with wider programmes that complies with WFP standards and procedures.
- Support the development of concept notes and proposals related to social protection initiatives and strategies.
- Participate in CO level capacity assessments such as the scoping studies and provide support to report writing.
- Support the development and review of social protection related strategic and operational documents such as strategies guidelines, manuals, among others for corporate guidance, COs and government.
- Contribute to the preparation of accurate and timely reports relevant to the social protection portfolios (e.g. programme status, performance) that will support WFP's decision-making at country and HQ level.

Provide Support to Social Protection Knowledge Management

- Document and disseminate lessons learned, best practices, and innovations from SP activities to inform programme adjustments and strategic planning.
- Support generating and applying evidence directly linked to WFP programme implementation, including operational research, pilot assessments, etc.
- Support programme-related data consolidation and analysis to support policy advocacy.
- Contribute to the development of knowledge products such as dashboards, briefs, and reports tailored to different audiences.
- Maintain and update SP data repositories and ensure accessibility for internal and external stakeholders.
- Support learning events such as webinars and community of practice by planning and facilitating the events.
- Support coordination of ongoing unit research pieces and studies by closely monitoring progress and quality against the TOR deliverables as well as provide any related administrative support as may be needed; take part in studies on gender and cash to improve the quality of cash programming.
- Act as the team's focal point on KM by working with the regional KM team and ensuring high quality KM support is provided at regional and country level.

Provide support to Social Protection Capacity Strengthening Initiatives

- Support identification of CO capacity building needs
- Work with team members to identify and implement/ appropriate training initiatives
- Support and coordinate South to South and Triangular Cooperation (SSTC) working closely with COs to develop ToRs, identify key learning objectives and the appropriate approach
- Closely collaborate with other relevant units within RBN such as CAM, KM, partnerships to facilitate their support to SSTC missions
- Support compilation and documentation of SSTC mission related information and ensure adequate dissemination.

Support regional Social Protection Partnerships

- Participate in partnership activities at regional level and support country level partnership engagements with various partners including government, donors, UN agencies, and other key stakeholders.
- Perform other related duties as required.

5. Qualifications and ExperienceEducation

Advanced university degree in Social Sciences, Public Policy, Public Administration, International Development, International Relations, Sociology, or other fields relevant to social protection.

Work experience

Previous work or internship experiences within the development sector.

Languages

Excellent written and spoken English is required (proficiency/level C). Working knowledge of another official UN language (French, Spanish, Arabic, Chinese, Russian plus Portuguese) is an advantage.

Other skills

- Strong analytical, written and oral communication skills, including the ability to write in an engaging and informative manner, and conceptualize and clearly synthesize information.
- Excellent interpersonal skills and team leadership skills.

- Ability to plan and organize work with minimum supervision.
- Ability to work under pressure and meet tight deadlines, while managing multiple priorities simultaneously.
- Initiative, enthusiasm, creativity and flexibility with excellent interpersonal skills and team spirit

Competencies

Professionalism

- Shows pride in work and in achievements.
- Demonstrates professional competence and mastery of subject matter.
- Is conscientious and efficient in meeting commitments, observing deadlines and achieving results.
- Is motivated by professional rather than personal concerns.
- Shows persistence when faced with difficult problems or challenges.
- Remains calm in stressful situation

Teamwork

- Works collaboratively with colleagues to achieve organizational goals.
- Solicits input by genuinely valuing others' ideas and expertise; is willing to learn from others.
- Places team agenda before personal agenda.
- Builds consensus for task purpose and direction with team members.
- Supports and acts in accordance with final group decisions, even when such decisions may not entirely reflect own position.
- Shares credit for team accomplishments and accepts joint responsibility for team shortcomings.

Planning & Organising

- Develops clear goals that are consistent with agreed strategies.
- Identifies priority activities and assignments; adjusts priorities as required.
- Allocates appropriate amount of time and resources for completing work.
- Foresees risks and allows for contingencies when planning.
- Monitors and adjusts plans and actions as necessary.
- Uses time efficiently

6. Learning Elements

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

- A solid practical and conceptual understanding of social protection and its role in enhancing food and nutrition security
- Exposure to a diverse range of social protection programmes and systems across the region.
- Familiarity with the operations of the United Nations in a dynamic and evolving development context.
- A comprehensive understanding of WFP's operations and activities within the region.

The selected candidate is expected to be able to:

- Apply social protection knowledge to provide technical advice for the design and implementation of national social protection programmes.
- Engage and work effectively with various stakeholders on key social protection policy and operational issues, particularly within the context of middle- and low-income countries in Sub-Saharan Africa.
- Undertake good quality social protection research and evidence generation.

- Support the development of good quality social protection advocacy and communication materials

7. Content and methodology of the supervision

Under the direct supervision of the Regional Social Protection Advisor, the incumbent will receive close mentoring and technical guidance. Upon arrival, the fellow will receive a briefing and background documents and will be introduced to the relevant working counterparts within and outside WFP. The social protection fellow will also be exposed to the overall WFP programming framework through collaboration with other technical teams. The fellow will be fully integrated in social protection team and involved in the day-to-day activities of the team. The supervision approach for the incumbent will include performance planning and reviews, as well as regular learning and development discussions. Support will be provided through daily interactions and a detailed annual work plan that clearly outlines key priorities, activities, and expected outputs. The fellow's work plan will be derived from the broader unit work plan to ensure alignment and contribution to the unit's overall annual goals. To monitor progress and provide continuous feedback, quarterly review sessions will be held. These sessions will help ensure the incumbent remains on track to achieve their objectives and receives timely support where needed.

8. Living conditions in the country

The WFP Regional Office for East and Southern Africa is located within the UN Compound in Nairobi, Kenya. Kenya is widely recognized for its friendly and welcoming atmosphere, vibrant culture, and energetic lifestyle. Strategically positioned on the East African coast, it serves as a central gateway to the region. Nairobi offers a range of advantages that make it an attractive destination for expatriates and international organizations, including several UN agencies—some of which have recently relocated or plan to establish their headquarters in Kenya.

The city features affordable modern housing, excellent flight connectivity, well-developed telecommunications and road infrastructure. Kenya also boasts high-quality healthcare, particularly in private hospitals located in major cities, which provide reliable medical services. For families, the country offers a selection of reputable international schools that meet global education standards. Despite the many positive attributes there are a number of concerns. High rates of crime, such as theft and muggings, are a significant concern, requiring precautions like living in secured communities. Inconsistent provision of utilities like electricity can be a major inconvenience, back-up power is encouraged. Heavy traffic congestion, particularly during peak hours, can make getting around cities like Nairobi difficult.